

KANT

CRITICAL STARTING PROBLEM AND → SYNTHETIC A PRIORI JUDGMENTS → TRANSCENDENTAL AESTHETIC: SPACE AND → CATEGORIES, SYNTHESIS AND TRANSCENDENTAL → SCHEMATISM: TEMPORAL BRIDGE FROM → ANALOGIES OF EXPERIENCE AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 CRITICAL STARTING PROBLEM AND THE RATIONALISM-EMPIRICISM SYNTHESIS

CRITICAL STARTING PROBLEM AND THE RATIONALISM-EMPIRICISM SYNTHESIS

HOW CAN COGNITION BE INFORMATIVE, NECESSARY AND OBJECTIVELY VALID?

A PRIORI NECESSITY, BUT DOGMATIC CLAIMS ABOUT SOUL, WORLD

SENSORY CONTENT, BUT NO EXPERIENCED NECESSARY CONNECTION

KANTIAN CRITIQUE

SENSORY MATTER + A PRIORI FORM, RESTRICTED TO POSSIBLE

COPERNICAN REVOLUTION

OBJECTS AS EXPERIENCED CONFORM TO COGNITIVE CONDITIONS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL QUESTION: How can cognition be informative, necessary and objectively valid?
- RATIONALISM → a priori necessity, but dogmatic claims about soul, world and God
- EMPIRICISM / HUME → sensory content, but no experienced necessary connection
- KANTIAN CRITIQUE → sensory matter + a priori form, restricted to possible experience

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- COPERNICAN REVOLUTION → objects AS EXPERIENCED conform to cognitive conditions
- SENSIBILITY → intuitions in space/time → UNDERSTANDING → categories and objects
- UNDERSTANDING → REASON → Ideas of Soul, World and God; drive to the unconditioned
- TRANSCENDENTAL = conditions of possible experience; TRANSCENDENT = beyond experience

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- RESULT → empirical realism + transcendental idealism + limit on theoretical reason
- ANSWER LINE → Kant secures objectivity by making its a priori conditions mind-given.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Sensory matter is received under space and time, synthesised through categories, and pursued toward unity by reason.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kant reconciles rationalism and empiricism by making a priori form the condition of experiential objectivity while denying that pure reason can convert those forms into knowledge of noumena.

01

STAGE 01 SYNTHETIC A PRIORI JUDGMENTS AND THE COPERNICAN EXPLANATION

SYNTHETIC A PRIORI JUDGMENTS AND THE COPERNICAN EXPLANATION

PREDICATE CONTAINED IN SUBJECT; DENIAL CONTRADICTS THE CONCEPT

PREDICATE ADDS CONTENT; DENIAL IS NOT SELF-CONTRADICTORY

A PRIORI

NECESSARY/UNIVERSAL WARRANT INDEPENDENT OF PARTICULAR EXPERIENCE

A POSTERIORI

EMPIRICAL, INFORMATIVE AND CONTINGENT WARRANT

ANALYTIC A PRIORI

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

ANALYTIC → predicate contained in subject; denial contradicts the concept
SYNTHETIC → predicate adds content; denial is not self-contradictory
A PRIORI → necessary/universal warrant independent of particular experience
A POSTERIORI → empirical, informative and contingent warrant

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

ANALYTIC A PRIORI → 'Bodies are extended'; ANALYTIC A POSTERIORI → no Kantian class
SYNTHETIC A POSTERIORI → 'This table is brown'; informative but contingent
SYNTHETIC A PRIORI → 7 + 5 = 12; every event has a cause; informative + necessary
HOW POSSIBLE? → the mind supplies space, time and categories to every appearance

EVALUATION / TRAP

MATHEMATICS / FUNDAMENTAL SCIENCE → valid for objects of possible experience
LIMIT → no inference from these forms to things in themselves or transcendent objects

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- ANALYTIC → predicate contained in subject; denial contradicts the concept
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MECHANISM / VERDICT — The knower supplies universal forms to sensory matter, making informative necessity possible for every object that can be experienced.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Synthetic a priori judgments are possible because objects of possible experience must conform to the mind's a priori forms, so mathematics and fundamental natural principles articulate conditions under which anything can appear as an object for us.

02

STAGE 02 TRANSCENDENTAL AESTHETIC: SPACE AND TIME AS FORMS OF INTUITION

TRANSCENDENTAL AESTHETIC

SPACE AND TIME AS FORMS OF INTUITION

FORM OF INTUITION

A PRIORI WAY IN WHICH SENSORY MATTER CAN BE

PURE FORM OF OUTER SENSE; COEXISTENCE, EXTERNALITY AND GEOMETRY

PURE FORM OF INNER SENSE; SUCCESSION AND ALL REPRESENTATIONS

A PRIORI ARGUMENT

SPATIAL/TEMPORAL ORDERING PRESUPPOSES, NOT PRODUCES, THE FORMS

FORM OF INTUITION → a priori way in which sensory matter can be given

SPACE → pure form of OUTER sense; coexistence, externality and geometry

TIME → pure form of INNER sense; succession and all representations

A PRIORI ARGUMENT → spatial/temporal ordering presupposes, not produces, the forms

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- FORM OF INTUITION → a priori way in which sensory matter can be given
- SPACE → pure form of OUTER sense; coexistence, externality and geometry
- TIME → pure form of INNER sense; succession and all representations
- A PRIORI ARGUMENT → spatial/temporal ordering presupposes, not produces, the forms

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- NECESSITY ARGUMENT → empty space/time is representable; objects without them are not
- INTUITION ARGUMENT → one space/time; regions and periods are limitations within it
- INFINITY ARGUMENT → magnitude is represented as a given whole, not instances under a concept
- EMPIRICALLY REAL → objectively valid for every appearance and possible experience

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- TRANSCENDENTALLY IDEAL → not properties of things in themselves
- OBJECTION → modern geometry/science pressures examples, not the whole transcendental strategy

03

FORM OF INTUITION → a priori way in which sensory matter can be given

SPACE → pure form of OUTER sense; coexistence, externality and geometry

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SOURCE / DOCTRINE

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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

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• OBJECTION → modern geometry/science pressures examples, not the whole transcendental strategy

MECHANISM / VERDICT → Space and time precede and organise sensory relations, allowing geometry, arithmetic, motion and ordered experience.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Space and time are empirically real because every appearance must be spatially or temporally ordered, yet transcendently ideal because neither can be attributed to things as they are independently of our sensibility.

03

STAGE 03 CATEGORIES, SYNTHESIS AND TRANSCENDENTAL UNITY OF APPERCEPTION

CATEGORIES, SYNTHESIS AND TRANSCENDENTAL UNITY OF APPERCEPTION

METAPHYSICAL DEDUCTION

IDENTIFIES CATEGORIES FROM FUNCTIONS OF JUDGMENT

TRANSCENDENTAL DEDUCTION

JUSTIFIES THEIR OBJECTIVE APPLICATION

SYNTHESIS UNDER RULES

'I THINK' CAN ACCOMPANY EACH REPRESENTATION

FORMAL UNITY OF SELF-CONSCIOUSNESS, NOT EMPIRICAL EGO OR SOUL-SUBSTANCE

QUANTITY → Unity

QUALITY → Reality

RELATION → Inherence/Subsistence

MODALITY → Possibility/Impossibility

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• QUANTITY → Unity

• QUALITY → Reality

• RELATION → Inherence/Subsistence

• MODALITY → Possibility/Impossibility

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• METAPHYSICAL DEDUCTION → identifies categories from functions of judgment

• TRANSCENDENTAL DEDUCTION → justifies their objective application

• MANIFOLD → SYNTHESIS under rules → 'I THINK' can accompany each representation

• APPERCEPTION → formal unity of self-consciousness, not empirical ego or soul-substance

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• OBJECTIVE UNITY → the same rule unites representations as one experience of objects

• LIMIT → categories constitute appearances only; they do not picture or determine noumena

MECHANISM / VERDICT → The same rules that unite representations in one consciousness also establish an objective order distinguishable from private association.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Transcendental Deduction justifies categories by showing that unified self-conscious experience is possible only through rule-governed synthesis, so the categories constitute objects of experience without depicting noumenal things.

04

STAGE 04 SCHEMATISM: TEMPORAL BRIDGE FROM PURE CATEGORY TO APPEARANCE

TEMPORAL BRIDGE FROM PURE CATEGORY TO APPEARANCE

PURE INTELLECTUAL CATEGORY AND SENSIBLE PARTICULAR APPEARANCE ARE HETEROGENEOUS

RULE/PROCEDURE OF PRODUCTIVE IMAGINATION; NEVER A DETERMINATE MENTAL IMAGE

WHY TIME?

IT IS A PRIORI LIKE THE CATEGORY AND CONTAINS

NUMBER THROUGH SUCCESSIVE HOMOGENEOUS ADDITION

DEGREE OR INTENSIVE MAGNITUDE

PERMANENCE, SUCCESSION BY RULE, RECIPROCAL COEXISTENCE

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• PROBLEM → pure intellectual category and sensible particular appearance are heterogeneous

• SCHEMA → rule/procedure of productive imagination; never a determinate mental image

• WHY TIME? → it is a priori like the category and contains every representation

• QUANTITY / time-series → NUMBER through successive homogeneous addition

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• QUALITY / time-content → DEGREE or intensive magnitude

• RELATION / time-order → permanence, succession by rule, reciprocal coexistence

• MODALITY / time-scope → some time, determinate time, all times

• DEDUCTION proves THAT categories apply; SCHEMATISM explains HOW they apply

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• UNSCHEMATISED CATEGORY → logical function without objective sense for appearances

• RESIDUAL → Kant calls the mediating operation an art concealed in the human soul

MECHANISM / VERDICT → Time-series, time-content, time-order and time-scope mediate Quantity, Quality, Relation and Modality.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Schematism converts logical functions into rules of temporal application, explaining how the Deduction's entitlement becomes usable for appearances while leaving unschematised categories without objective sense.

05

STAGE 05 ANALOGIES OF EXPERIENCE AND KANT'S PRECISE ANSWER TO HUME

ANALOGIES OF EXPERIENCE AND KANT'S PRECISE ANSWER TO HUME

MASTER PREMISE

TIME ITSELF CANNOT BE PERCEIVED; OBJECTIVE TIME NEEDS PROXIES

FIRST ANALOGY

SUBSTANCE PERSISTS WHILE ITS STATES ALTER

SECOND ANALOGY

EVERY EVENT FOLLOWS ACCORDING TO A CAUSAL RULE

THIRD ANALOGY

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
MASTER PREMISE → time itself cannot be perceived; objective time needs proxies	HOUSE → viewing order is reversible; succession belongs to my apprehension	STRAWSON OBJECTION → involuntary order does not automatically prove natural necessity
FIRST ANALOGY / duration → substance persists while its states alter	SHIP DOWNSTREAM → order is irreversible; an objective event requires a rule	VERDICT → Kant secures entitlement to causality more clearly than any particular law
SECOND ANALOGY / succession → every event follows according to a causal rule	ANTI-HUME MOVE → causality is a condition of judging objective succession, not habit	

KANT • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2775-6009 of 11560 • continues below

05

STAGE 05

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THIRD ANALOGY / simultaneity → substances coexist through reciprocal community	QUALIFICATION → particular causal laws remain empirical and require investigation	

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

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DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- HOUSE → viewing order is reversible; succession belongs to my apprehension
- SHIP DOWNSTREAM → order is irreversible; an objective event requires a rule
- ANTI-HUME MOVE → causality is a condition of judging objective succession, not habit
- QUALIFICATION → particular causal laws remain empirical and require investigation

EVALUATION / TRAP

- STRAWSON OBJECTION → involuntary order does not automatically prove natural necessity
- VERDICT → Kant secures entitlement to causality more clearly than any particular law

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Persistent substance, irreversible succession under a rule, and reciprocal interaction act as proxies for duration, succession and simultaneity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kant answers Hume by arguing that causality is not inferred from repetition but presupposed in judging a succession as an objective event, though particular causal laws remain empirical.

06

STAGE 06

PHENOMENA, NOUMENA, EMPIRICAL REALISM AND THE IDEALISM BOUNDARY

PHENOMENA, NOUMENA, EMPIRICAL REALISM AND THE IDEALISM BOUNDARY

OBJECT AS GIVEN IN SPACE/TIME AND THOUGHT THROUGH CATEGORIES

POSSIBLE EXPERIENCE

KNOWABLE, PUBLIC, CAUSAL AND SCIENTIFICALLY INVESTIGABLE DOMAIN

NOUMENON NEGATIVELY

THING CONSIDERED APART FROM SENSIBLE INTUITION; LIMITING CONCEPT

NOUMENON IS THINKABLE, NOT KNOWABLE

NO THEORETICAL PREDICATES FROM THE CATEGORIES

PHENOMENON → object as given in space/time and thought through categories

POSSIBLE EXPERIENCE → knowable, public, causal and scientifically investigable domain

NOUMENON NEGATIVELY → thing considered apart from sensible intuition; limiting concept

NOUMENON IS THINKABLE, NOT KNOWABLE → no theoretical predicates from the categories

TRANSCENDENTAL IDEALISM → our forms condition appearances

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PHENOMENON → object as given in space/time and thought through categories
- POSSIBLE EXPERIENCE → knowable, public, causal and scientifically investigable domain
- NOUMENON NEGATIVELY → thing considered apart from sensible intuition; limiting concept
- NOUMENON IS THINKABLE, NOT KNOWABLE → no theoretical predicates from the categories

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- TRANSCENDENTAL IDEALISM → our forms condition appearances
- EMPIRICAL REALISM → external objects are real within experience, not private illusions
- REFUTATION → determinate inner time-awareness requires an empirically external permanent
- TWO-ASPECT READING → one object considered as appearance and independently of our access

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- HEGEL/JACOBI PRESSURE → boundary knowledge and affection threaten internal consistency
- SAFE VERDICT → negative limitation is defensible; positive noumenal causation is not

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Cognitive conditions establish the knowable phenomenal domain and simultaneously forbid constitutive claims beyond it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kant combines transcendental idealism with empirical realism: appearances are objective and public within experience, although categories cannot be extended to things in themselves.

07

STAGE 07

IDEAS OF REASON, REGULATIVE UNITY AND NATURAL TRANSCENDENTAL ILLUSION

IDEAS OF REASON, REGULATIVE UNITY AND NATURAL TRANSCENDENTAL ILLUSION

SUPPLIES RULES FOR APPEARANCES; REASON

SEEKS THE UNCONDITIONED

PROJECTED COMPLETE UNITY OF INNER CONDITIONS

PROJECTED COMPLETE TOTALITY OF COSMOLOGICAL CONDITIONS

PROJECTED COMPLETE GROUND OF ALL CONDITIONS AND REALITY

REGULATIVE USE

GUIDE INQUIRY TOWARD SYSTEMATIC UNITY; LEGITIMATE 'AS IF'

SOUL → projected complete unity of inner conditions

WORLD → projected complete totality of cosmological conditions

GOD → projected complete ground of all conditions and reality

UNDERSTANDING → supplies rules for appearances; REASON → seeks the unconditioned

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- UNDERSTANDING → supplies rules for appearances; REASON → seeks the unconditioned
- SOUL → projected complete unity of inner conditions
- WORLD → projected complete totality of cosmological conditions
- GOD → projected complete ground of all conditions and reality

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- REGULATIVE USE → guide inquiry toward systematic unity; legitimate 'as if'
- CONSTITUTIVE USE → claim the Idea determines a known object; illegitimate
- TRANSCENDENTAL ILLUSION → natural and persistent drive to reify completion
- PARALOGISM → logical 'I think' is misread as simple, substantial, enduring soul

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VALUE → systematic research and explanatory integration
- DANGER → paralogisms, antinomies and speculative theology

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Reason projects complete explanatory unity and then mistakes a methodological ideal for a constitutively given object.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Transcendental illusion is natural and persistent because reason cannot stop seeking completion, yet critique can prevent the slide from useful systematic unity to metaphysical claims about soul-substance, world-totality and God.

- WORLD → projected complete totality of cosmological conditions
- GOD → projected complete ground of all conditions and reality

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Reason projects complete explanatory unity and then mistakes a methodological ideal for a constitutively given object.

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08

STAGE 08

FOUR COSMOLOGICAL ANTINOMIES AND THEIR DIFFERENTIATED RESOLUTIONS

FOUR COSMOLOGICAL ANTINOMIES AND THEIR DIFFERENTIATED RESOLUTIONS1 THESISBEGINNING IN TIME + SPATIAL LIMITINFINITE TIME/SPACE2 THESISCOMPOSITES END IN SIMPLE PARTSNOTHING SIMPLE EXISTS3 THESIS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- 1 THESIS → beginning in time + spatial limit
- ANTITHESIS → infinite time/space
- 2 THESIS → composites end in simple parts
- ANTITHESIS → nothing simple exists
- 3 THESIS → freedom besides nature

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ANTITHESIS → universal natural causality
- 4 THESIS → absolutely necessary being
- ANTITHESIS → no necessary being
- SOURCE OF CONFLICT → categories applied to the world-series as a completed whole
- MATHEMATICAL 1-2 → reject shared assumption that a finite/infinite whole is given

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DYNAMICAL 3-4 → phenomenal conditions and intelligible standpoint can be distinguished
- FREEDOM → thinkable noumenally while every appearance remains naturally determined
- NECESSARY GROUND → thinkable boundary, not theoretical proof of God
- SIGNIFICANCE → indirect case for idealism and limit of speculative metaphysics

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Reason demands the unconditioned, turns a never-completed experiential series into a total object, and proves opposed predicates of that pseudo-object.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Transcendental idealism resolves the mathematical antinomies by rejecting the shared assumption of a given world-whole, while it reconciles the dynamical antinomies by distinguishing phenomenal natural conditions from a merely intelligible standpoint.

09

STAGE 09

GOD-PROOF CRITIQUE, EVALUATION LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQS AND ANSWER SPINE

GOD-PROOF CRITIQUE, EVALUATION LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQS AND ANSWER SPINEPERFECT CONCEPT INCLUDES EXISTENCEEXISTENCE ADDS NO CONTENT100 POSSIBLE/ACTUAL THALERSSAME CONCEPT; ACTUALITY CANNOT BE EXTRACTED ANALYTICALLYCONTINGENT EXISTS, THEREFORE NECESSARY GOD

ILLICIT CAUSAL EXTENSIONCOSMOLOGICAL DEPENDENCE

ONTOLOGICAL — perfect concept includes existence → KANT — existence adds no content → 100 possible/actual thalers — same concept; actuality cannot be extracted analytically → COSMOLOGICAL — contingent exists, therefore necessary God → illicit causal extension

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- ONTOLOGICAL → perfect concept includes existence
- KANT → existence adds no content
- 100 possible/actual thalers → same concept; actuality cannot be extracted analytically
- COSMOLOGICAL → contingent exists, therefore necessary God
- illicit causal extension

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- COSMOLOGICAL DEPENDENCE → necessary being = ens realissimum repeats ontological proof
- DESIGN → order implies designer
- at most an architect, not necessary creator
- DESIGN DEPENDENCE → creator/necessity needs cosmological then ontological steps
- BOUNDARY → theoretical proof fails; this is not a demonstration of atheism

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- COMPARISON → rationalist necessity + empiricist content under critical limitation
- PYQ ROUTES → synthesis, space/time, apperception, antinomies, Hume and God proofs
- ANSWER SPINE → thesis → doctrine → argument → objection/reply → qualified verdict
- FINAL VERDICT → Kant gains phenomenal objectivity at the cost of noumenal agnosticism

MECHANISM / VERDICT — All three routes attempt to turn thought beyond experience into constitutive knowledge, and the latter two ultimately require the ontological step.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kant's critique removes God from theoretical knowledge rather than from thought or practical faith, completing a system that secures phenomenal objectivity precisely by refusing constitutive claims beyond possible experience.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENTADVANCED SESSION 1 — THE CRITICAL PROJECT - HUME'SADVANCED SESSION 2 — THE CENTRAL PROBLEM - POSSIBILITYADVANCED SESSION 3 — TRANSCENDENTAL AESTHETIC - SPACE ANDADVANCED SESSION 4 — TRANSCENDENTAL ANALYTIC - CATEGORIES, DEDUCTIONADVANCED SESSION 5 — THE SCHEMATISM - BRIDGING CATEGORIESADVANCED SESSION 6 — THE ANALOGIES OF EXPERIENCEADVANCED SESSION 7 — REFUTATION OF IDEALISM; PHENOMENA AND

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — The Critical Project - Hume's Trigger, the Copernican Revolution and the Transcendental Method
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — The Central Problem - Possibility of Synthetic A Priori Judgments
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Transcendental Aesthetic - Space and Time
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Transcendental Analytic - Categories, Deduction, Apperception; 'Understanding makes Nature'

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — The Schematism - Bridging Categories and Intuition by Time-Determination
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — The Analogies of Experience - Substance, Causality, Community; the Real Answer to Hume
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Refutation of Idealism; Phenomena and Noumena
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Ideas of Reason - Soul, World, God; Regulative vs Constitutive; the Paralogisms

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — The Antinomies of Pure Reason
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Critique of the Proofs for the Existence of God
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- Core prerequisite : finish the owner first for Synthetic a priori judgments

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.